

ANDROID RELEASE / CREATIVE + SHOOT PLAN

Useless Android Launch - Production Brief

Date: 2026-09-03
Language on camera: English
Deliverables: one fast launch film, one slow escalating-reveal film, plus reusable B-roll for a later voice-over edit

1. Research read: what the references actually do

Observed facts

Reference	Public snapshot	Transcript/story mechanism
Original Useless launch	179.7K likes; about 900 comments in the reviewed snapshot; posted 2026-02-13	Opens in a graveyard with a large life-loss claim, briefly misdirects the viewer, then makes one unusual mechanism the hero: asking friends for permission to scroll. The demo becomes a social scene, followed by the Walk of Shame and a mission line.
Later Useless video: message to social apps	34 likes and 7 comments in the reviewed snapshot; posted 2026-07-05	Starts with a grand declaration about building the world's biggest screen-time app, gives almost no human situation or proof, and moves quickly to the product CTA.
Later Useless explainer	27 likes and 5 comments in the reviewed snapshot; posted 2026-07-04	Reuses much of the original problem/feature structure, but adds a longer walkthrough and has no fresh social conflict or Android-specific payoff.
Competitor mini-documentary	128.8K likes and 11.6K comments in the reviewed snapshot; posted 2026-06-01	Begins as a human/team story, uses warm real-world locations and handmade props, introduces unexpected demand, then reframes the mission from reducing screen time to helping friends do more together. The product is the consequence of the story, not the opening subject.

The supplied Android screenshots add direct proof of repeated demand: people explicitly asked for Play Store/Android access, one visible comment had 517 likes, and several comments framed Android as the reason they could not join.

Interpretation, not proven causality

- The original Useless film likely worked because the viewer first entered an odd situation and only then received the explanation. The app mechanic created interpersonal tension: ask, justify, wait, get judged.

- The two weaker follow-ups likely feel more like ads because they announce the company ambition or explain the feature before giving the viewer a person, conflict, or unanswered question. Distribution and timing may also have affected performance; public metrics alone cannot prove why a post underperformed.
- The competitor's strongest transferable principle is not its wording. It is the sequence: people first, shared problem second, product proof third, mission/payoff last.

Creative rule for this launch

Do not lead with "Useless is now on Android." Lead with a contradiction that Android resolves:

We built an app for friends, but half the friends were missing.

Only one feature needs explaining: when your limit is reached, more time requires a photo and an explanation sent to friends. The Android release is emotionally relevant because that accountability loop finally includes the whole group.

2. Time-saving line: mathematically clean version

- Two hours saved per day = 730 hours per year = 30.4 full days.
- Sustained for 60 years = 43,800 hours = 1,825 days = exactly five 365-day years.
- Honest spoken version: "If I go from five hours to three, that's a full month back every year - five years over sixty."
- Do not say the app itself guarantees those five years. It is a personal hypothetical based on maintaining a two-hour daily reduction.

3. Film A - Fast launch: "The Most Useless Thing"

Target length: 27-31 seconds

Energy: dry, self-aware, fast

Core gap: What was the most useless thing about Useless?

Reveal: iPhone-only

Rehook: It was not merely a store problem; a friend app without friends is structurally incomplete.

Final direct-to-camera script

We finally fixed the most useless thing about Useless.

It was iPhone-only.

And apparently, you had thoughts. A lot of thoughts.

But that wasn't just a Play Store problem. A friends app without half your friends is... kind of useless.

With Useless, your distracting apps lock. Want more time? Send your friends a photo, explain yourself, and let them decide.

If I go from five hours to three, that's a full month back every year - five years over sixty.

Android friends: you're finally in. Useless is now on Android.

Beat and shot plan

Time	Spoken beat	Shot/action	Lens and framing	Edit/text
0.0-1.8	"We finally fixed..."	Presenter snaps a paper strip reading iPHONE ONLY off a phone or small Useless sign. Direct eye contact.	15mm, tight chest-up, very close to lens	Hard start on movement. Text: THE MOST USELESS THING?
1.8-3.0	"It was iPhone-only."	Android phone sits outside a taped circle while two friends stand inside it.	45-150mm around 70-100mm, compressed close insert	One dead-silent half beat after "only."
3.0-5.8	"You had thoughts..."	Four 0.6-second inserts: printer output, comment slapped onto glass, comment screenshot on phone, presenter disappearing behind comment pages.	45-150mm details, then 15mm reaction	Use the real supplied comments, but crop or blur handles and avatars. Text lands one word at a time: A. LOT. OF. THOUGHTS.
5.8-9.5	"But that wasn't..."	Two friends use the app; Android friend is visibly separated by glass, tape, or a tiny queue barrier. Everyone treats the absurd boundary as normal.	7.5mm wide, camera level	Rehook text: NOT JUST A PLAY STORE PROBLEM
9.5-12.0	"A friends app..."	Presenter looks from the group to the excluded friend, then back to lens on the word "useless."	15mm medium	Let the pause and glance carry the joke; no effect needed.
12.0-17.5	Feature sentence	Limit screen, attempted open, photo request, typed excuse, friend presses deny. Use hands and reactions rather than a long screen recording.	45-150mm inserts plus one 15mm two-shot	Three quick labels only: LIMIT -> EXPLAIN YOURSELF -> FRIENDS DECIDE
17.5-23.0	Personal time example	Screen-time card changes from 5h to 3h; thirty paper calendar squares drop or are swept back to presenter.	45-150mm detail; 15mm overhead if safe	Text: 2H/DAY = 30 DAYS/YEAR; then smaller: = 5 YEARS OVER 60
23.0-27.0	"Android friends..."	Barrier is removed. Android friend steps into the group and instantly receives a deliberately embarrassing request selfie.	7.5mm energetic wide	The group laughs; music briefly opens up.
27.0-30.0	Final line	Clean Android phone hero close-up with all three people soft in background.	15mm at f/1.7-2.2 or 45mm end of zoom	End card: USELESS - NOW ON ANDROID plus small store mark/link cue. No additional spoken sales CTA.

Three hook variants to record while the setup is live

1. "We finally fixed the most useless thing about Useless."
2. "Our friends app had one problem: half our friends couldn't use it."
3. "You asked us one question so often... we printed it."

Best default: variant 1. It contains the brand, a paradox, and an immediate information gap without sounding like a launch ad.

4. Film B - Slow reveal: "The Android Waiting Room"

Target length: 36-43 seconds

Energy: cinematic, dry, increasingly strange

Core gap: Why did a friendship app lock its own friends outside?

Final visual answer: the waiting crowd/comment installation is Android.

Physical concept

Create a formal waiting room where no waiting room belongs: three office chairs, a number ticket, and a queue line outside a glass university/office entrance or on an open courtyard. Start so tight that it looks ordinary. Every cut moves farther away and reveals something less normal:

1. a person waiting with a numbered ticket;
2. another person behind a closed glass door;
3. office chairs and a queue barrier outside;
4. dozens of printed Android comments covering the glass;
5. final high ultra-wide: the papers form a large ANDROID? or point toward the locked door.

The presenter stays calm and speaks as if none of this is unusual. That contrast creates the comedy.

Final direct-to-camera script

We built an app for friends... and somehow locked half our friends outside.

They waited. And waited. And kept reminding us in the comments.

A lot.

But here's the awkward part: without them, the app made less sense.

Useless gives screen time actual social consequences. Hit your limit and there is no quiet "ignore" button.

Want more time? Send your friends a photo and explain yourself. They decide whether your excuse deserves another scroll.

But the friend with Android? Still outside.

Well... we finally opened the door.

Useless is now on Android. The whole friend group can finally be useless together.

Escalating-reveal shot plan

Time	Visual reveal	Performance/blocking	Lens and execution	Audio/text
0.0-2.8	Only face, ticket, and edge of a closed door are visible. Context looks like an ordinary wait.	Presenter looks into lens; waiting friend remains an indistinct shape.	45-150mm around 100-130mm, tripod, long distance, shallow background	"We built an app for friends..." Text: AN APP FOR FRIENDS
2.8-5.5	Medium reveals a friend literally outside the door holding an Android phone and ticket.	Presenter finishes "...locked half our friends outside." Friend knocks once without emotion.	15mm, locked medium	Text changes to . . . THAT LOCKED FRIENDS OUT?
5.5-9.0	Wider reveal: two waiting chairs, queue tape, second friend, a few comment pages.	Both friends check the time in sync.	15mm wide; no handheld movement	Natural chair/foot sounds under dialogue.
9.0-12.0	Much wider reveal: glass/wall is covered in comments.	Presenter delivers "A lot" completely straight.	7.5mm, level horizon, symmetrical frame	Drop music for "A lot." Hold 6-8 frames longer than comfortable.
12.0-17.0	Return to a composed medium; the absurd room remains visible behind.	Presenter steps toward lens for the rehook.	15mm, very slow physical push or one clean cut	Rehook text: WITHOUT THEM, IT MADE LESS SENSE
17.0-23.0	Close B-roll: blocked distracting app; finger searches for an ignore button that is not there.	Dialogue continues as voice from the same take.	45-150mm around 70-100mm	Text: NO QUIET "IGNORE"
23.0-29.0	Photo request and short excuse travel to a friend's phone; friend calmly denies it.	Use a funny but plausible selfie, not a polished product demo.	45-150mm hand inserts; 15mm reaction two-shot	Text: YOUR FRIENDS DECIDE
29.0-33.0	Final mystery reveal: high/ultra-wide shows ANDROID? made from the comment sheets or a large sign among them.	Android friend points at phone on "Still outside."	7.5mm from a safely secured ladder position or raised balcony	This is the information-gap payoff.
33.0-37.0	Presenter opens the door/removes tape. Waiting friends enter with exaggerated normality.	No cheering yet; play it dry.	15mm wide, one lateral move	Door click becomes the musical release.
37.0-42.0	All three sit together; one immediately sends a request and gets rejected.	Group finally breaks character/laughs.	7.5mm final wide, then optional 45-150mm phone insert	End card: USELESS IS NOW ON ANDROID / THE WHOLE GROUP IS IN

Three hook variants to record

1. "We built an app for friends... and somehow locked half our friends outside."
2. "We've kept these people waiting for something completely useless."
3. "This might be the world's saddest Android waiting room."

Best default: variant 1. It states the category by second five, preserves the reason for the lockout until later, and gives the visuals a literal job.

5. Shared B-roll bank for the later voice-over upload

Capture every insert in both normal speed and 50 fps. Hold each action for at least three seconds before and after the useful movement.

1. Printer feeding out an Android comment.
2. Stack of comments hitting a table.
3. Tight rack focus from "Android?" on paper to the Android phone.
4. Five-hour screen-time card changing to three hours.
5. Thirty calendar squares/pages moving back toward the presenter.
6. Distracting app hitting its limit.
7. Finger looking for an override and failing.
8. Deliberately awkward request selfie being taken.
9. One-sentence excuse being typed.
10. Friend receives request, looks at camera, and denies it.
11. Walk-of-Shame screen/detail if the current Android build is stable enough to show.
12. Door/tape/barrier opening.
13. Android friend stepping into the group.
14. Three-phone overhead with Useless visible on Android.
15. Clean 5-8 second hero shot with empty space for end-card copy.

Voice-over re-upload opening:

We printed every comment asking for Android. That was a mistake. But it showed us something: a friends app does not work when half the group is missing.

Use a different first three seconds, different music, a new caption, and at least two unused shots so the second edit stands on its own creatively.

6. Camera, sound, and practical execution

Lens roles

- **45-150mm:** the "normal" opening of Film B. Compression hides the surroundings and makes the later widening meaningful. Also use it for phone, hand, printer, and expression inserts.
- **15mm f/1.7:** main direct-to-camera lens, two-shots, doorway medium shots, and the phone hero with people behind it. This should carry most dialogue.
- **7.5mm Walimex Pro:** only for the largest reveal, overhead comment shape, or one intentionally distorted close shot. Keep the camera level so the frame looks designed rather than accidentally bent.

Capture settings and continuity

- In Germany, use 25 fps with a 1/50 shutter for dialogue to reduce common artificial-light flicker. Use 50 fps with roughly 1/100 for B-roll intended for slow motion.
- Lock white balance and exposure within each location. Auto shifts will make the high-quality sequence feel inconsistent.
- Record the DJI transmitter internally as a safety track and feed the receiver to camera for sync/reference. Hide it when possible; the waiting-room film should feel like a scene, not an interview.
- Record every spoken clause as a complete clean take in its assigned framing. Then record 10 seconds of room tone and one clean plate of every composition.
- Frame vertically from the start. Keep eyes around the upper third and reserve one side of frame for captions; avoid covering faces with large center text.

Prop list

- 30-50 A5/A4 Android comment prints, with usernames and avatars removed or blurred.
- One roll of removable painter's tape; do not use permanent adhesive on public glass/walls.
- Two or three mismatched office/waiting-room chairs.
- Simple paper number tickets and a WAITING ROOM sign.
- Optional queue rope made from two stands and cord.
- One large ANDROID? reveal sign, or enough pages to form the word from above.
- Three phones or phone-shaped foam/printed props for the wide installation; hero phone must show the real current Android build.

Location and safety

Use a side entrance, courtyard, or glass wall where the setup does not block a real doorway, emergency exit, pavement, or public transport flow. For the ladder shot, keep one person spotting and secure the camera; a balcony or staircase landing is preferable if available.

7. Edit and sound rules

Film A

- 12-15 shots in about 30 seconds.
- First cut before second two; comments may run at 0.5-0.8 seconds each.
- Keep the feature explanation to one visual chain and three labels.
- Use one rehook card only. More cards will turn it into a product explainer.
- End with logo/store cue for 1.0-1.5 seconds; do not add a second spoken CTA.

Film B

- Let the first four framings breathe: roughly 2.5, 2.5, 3.5, and 3 seconds.
- Keep the presenter in nearly the same screen position while the world expands around them.
- Use sound to make the reveal bigger: ticket tear, chair scrape, printer, knock, then a silence before "A lot."
- Avoid trendy whip transitions. The joke is that the camera is serious while the set becomes absurd.

8. What not to repeat from the references

- Do not reuse the graveyard, the "addiction stealing years" opening, or source hooks word for word.
- Do not begin with a claim about becoming the biggest screen-time app.
- Do not explain the leaderboard, focus mode, requests, Walk of Shame, and every setting in one launch video.
- Do not make the Android announcement the first sentence; it should close the gap the story created.
- Do not use fake comments, inflated counts, or unverified download numbers. The real comment screenshots are already stronger.

9. Recommended shoot order

1. Film B telephoto and 15mm dialogue while the public location is quiet.
2. Build out the waiting-room set progressively and capture each wider reveal.
3. Shoot the final 7.5mm/high reveal and door-opening payoff.
4. Shoot Film A dialogue in the same wardrobe but a tighter, brighter setup.
5. Capture all phone UI inserts last, after confirming the Android build and removing private notifications/data.
6. Capture the entire shared B-roll bank before breaking down the props.